

Hackles Club: The Hackles Patch Skills Checklist

The Hackles Kit

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell.

FIELD COPY

1



Lock It

PASSWORDS AND ACCOUNTS

2



Spot It

SCAMS AND FAKES

3



Share Smart

PRIVACY

4



Safe People

WHO TO TRUST

5



Kind and Well

KINDNESS AND BALANCE

6



Fix It

TELL, REPAIR, RECOVER

PLATE I. The six strands, hand-in-inked, in the order the lessons take them.

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[Logo: Hackles]

Trust your hackles. *Pause · Check · Tell*

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FIELD NOTE	No. 1
Plain statement of independence. The Hackles Patch is an original program written by Competence Collective for the Hackles Club. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by or sponsored by any scouting organisation or any other youth organisation. It does not use, copy or imitate any other organisation's badges, ranks, uniforms, names, symbols or trademarks, and it must not be presented as if it did. If your group belongs to a larger organisation, the Hackles Patch is an extra activity of your own group. It does not count toward, and is not an alternative to, any award from that organisation unless that organisation says so in writing. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM, including a trademark check on the name "Hackles Patch" before any patches are manufactured or sold.]	

01 What the Hackles Patch is

THE HACKLES PATCH IS a skills checklist that a child works through at the child's own pace, in the Club or at home. Each skill is something a child can **do**, not something a child has to memorize. A leader or a trusted adult initials each skill when they see it. Completing a level earns a patch (a paper or cloth patch, a sticker, a stamp or just a certificate).

Why a checklist. Kids like to know what comes next. A checklist shows a child that practice adds up.

What it is not. It is not a competition. It is not a ranking. Nobody is behind, and nobody loses a patch. A child can skip any skill, and a leader never asks why. The only record is the paper in the child's own hands.

SPECIMEN LABEL	
LEVELS	Three: Level 1 Notice, Level 2 Practice, Level 3 Teach
SKILL AREAS	Eight, one for each part of the Hackles routine and the Crew
AGES	Wording for 5-7, 8-11 and 12-15 in each area
WHERE	In a Club session, at home with a family adult, or at a library
WHO SIGNS	A Club leader, a parent or carer, a librarian or another adult the family trusts. A child never signs their own.
RECORDS	The child keeps the checklist. The Club keeps no record of any child.
COST	A printed page. Optional: stickers or iron-on patches [see the badge brief, file 13]

02 The eight skill areas

#	SKILL AREA	CREW	THE MOVE
1	Notice	Hackle	Hackles up?
2	Pause	Hackle	Pause
3	Check	Peeper	Check
4	Tell	Buddy, Fixit	Tell
5	Lock It	Latch	Passwords and passphrases
6	Share Smart	Pip	Privacy
7	Kind and Calm	Ember	Kindness and screen breaks
8	Fix It	Fixit, Rinse	Oops recovery and family plans

03 The checklist

How to read the table. Each row is one skill. A child picks the column for their age, or any column they like. A leader or adult initials in the last column. "Initial" means the adult's initials. No child names or details are written.

SKILL 1: NOTICE (HACKLES UP?)

LEVEL	AGES 5-7	AGES 8-11	AGES 12-15	ADULT INITIALS
1	Do the Hackles Up move and say what it means ("something feels odd")	Name two feelings that mean hackles up (too good, pushy, secret, scary)	Name three cues that something is off (fast, flattering, secret, odd)	
2	Show hackles up for 3 different pretend messages	Use hackles up on 3 cards and name the clue	Spot FLAGS on 3 cards	
3	Teach the move to a younger child or family member	Explain "a false alarm is fine" to a friend	Explain why a false alarm is welcome to a younger person	

SKILL 2: PAUSE

LEVEL	AGES 5-7	AGES 8-11	AGES 12-15	ADULT INITIALS
1	Show the Pause Palm when the leader says "Gifty!"	Pause on cue 3 times in a row (Pause Palm Freeze)	Name what you do in the first five seconds of an odd message	
2	Take one slow breath before answering a card	Pause and breathe before a Tell practice	Name one situation where pausing is hard and a trick to do it	
3	Help a friend pause	Lead the freeze game for the group	Lead a short pause practice for a group	

SKILL 3: CHECK

LEVEL	AGES 5-7	AGES 8-11	AGES 12-15	ADULT INITIALS
1	Sort 4 pop-up cards: FISHY, REAL or PAUSE AND ASK	Sort 6 cards and name one SPOT clue	Sort 6 cards and name a second channel	
2	Say how you would check one card ("I would ask a grown-up")	Check a pretend link a different way	Use "hang up, look up, call back" in a role-play	
3	Show a family adult the three answer signals	Lead a Quick Catch round	Explain the difference between a real and a fishy twin	

SKILL 4: TELL

LEVEL	AGES 5-7	AGES 8-11	AGES 12-15	ADULT INITIALS
1	Name two grown-ups you would tell (Trusted Hand)	Name three people on your Help Ladder	Say a three-sentence Tell script (need, facts, ask)	
2	Say "I need help with something online" to a grown-up or a puppet	Climb to the next rung in a role-play when the first person does not help	Use the Next-Rung Rule in a role-play	
3	Practice with a family adult	Teach a friend the Help Ladder	Teach the Tell-3 script to a younger child	

SKILL 5: LOCK IT

LEVEL	AGES 5-7	AGES 8-11	AGES 12-15	ADULT INITIALS
1	Make a silly three-word password out loud (not a real one)	Build a four-word practice passphrase (not a real one)	Tell a strong from a weak password and say why	
2	Say who can know a password (me and my trusted grown-up)	Say no kindly when a friend asks for a password	Rank sign-in methods from strongest to weakest	
3	Whisper-play the Silly Vault game with a family adult	Teach the Passphrase Rap to a friend	Explain why one password per account matters	

SKILL 6: SHARE SMART

LEVEL	AGES 5-7	AGES 8-11	AGES 12-15	ADULT INITIALS
1	Sort 4 cards into SHARE and SHELL	Sort 6 items into private and public	Name two permissions an app might not need	
2	Ask "Do all my friends say OK?" before a photo, in a role-play	Explain the mosaic effect using the made-up Quinn	Audit a pretend app's permissions	
3	Show a family adult the Share or Shell game	Teach "ask before you post" to a friend	Teach a younger person one privacy setting that matters	

SKILL 7: KIND AND CALM

LEVEL	AGES 5-7	AGES 8-11	AGES 12-15	ADULT INITIALS
1	Say one kind thing to a partner	Name the four upstander moves (Say It, Stand With, Keep It, Tell It)	Name two ways to Stand With someone	
2	Do Ember's Warm Breath	Pick a move in a scenario and say why	Practice Say It and Stand With in a role-play	
3	Plan one screen-free time with your family	Take a screen break and say how you felt	Notice when a feed is pulling you in and take a break	

SKILL 8: FIX IT

LEVEL	AGES 5-7	AGES 8-11	AGES 12-15	ADULT INITIALS
1	Say "I made an oops, I need help"	Do the four O.O.P.S. steps in order	Put the five Oops Path steps in order	
2	Hear and say the Good Grown-up Reply	Make a family code word idea (kept private)	Explain a family code word and the callback rule	
3	Use the Tell Wave to teach a friend	Say the Good Grown-up Reply as the listener	Practice being the Listener in a role-play	

04 Earning a patch

LEVEL	RULE	PATCH
Level 1 Notice	Any 6 of the 8 skills at Level 1	Level 1 patch
Level 2 Practice	Any 6 of the 8 skills at Level 2	Level 2 patch
Level 3 Teach	Any 6 of the 8 skills at Level 3	Level 3 patch

Rules.

- A child may mix age columns. A 7-year-old who wants a 8-11 skill may try it.
- A child may skip any skill. Six of eight is enough.
- Skills can be done in any order and in any setting.
- No skill involves real accounts, real passwords or real names.
- A false alarm earns the same initials as a right answer.
- A Level 3 skill is about **teaching a pretend practice**, not about performing in front of others. A child may teach one person.
- No child is ever required to earn a patch. Participation in the Club does not depend on it.

05 What leaders do

- Keep the checklist copies in a folder. Give each child one at the first session.
- Initial skills when you see them. Use your own initials or a stamp.
- Do not write names on any master list. The child keeps the page.
- Reward the effort. Say, "Nice noticing." Do not say, "You are the best."
- At the end of the Club, hand out the Level 1 patch to children who earned it.
- Skills can also be earned at home with a family adult initialing.

06 Making a patch

SEE THE DESIGN BRIEF in file 13_Certificate_and_Badge_Design_Brief.md. A patch can be a printed round sticker, a paper badge pinned with tape, a stamp on the passport, or an iron-on patch if your host organisation chooses to buy one. **Do not copy the shape, border style, rank names or uniform styling of any other organisation's awards.**

Words to avoid in your own materials: "merit badge", "rank", "Eagle", "scouting award", "badge of honor" or the name of any real organisation next to the Hackles Patch. Say "Hackles Patch" and "skill".

07 **Printables checklist**

- ☐ One copy of Section 3 per child (3 pages).
- ☐ A copy of the independence statement posted where families can see it.
- ☐ Stickers, stamps or patches for each level.
- ☐ A pen for initials.